



For the Builders of Black Independence

Minister Louis Farrakhan

Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development

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Léandre Poplus, Founder

For Our People, By Our People.

ALLIANCE FOR COLLECTIVE EMPOWERMENT

ACE

As-Salamu Alaykum, Minister Farrakhan.

My name is Léandre Poplus. I am the founder of the Alliance for Collective Empowerment and Development. For more than twenty years, the clarity of your ministry's position on Black sovereignty, self-determination, and the impossibility of true freedom inside a system built to deny it has shaped how I think about what Black people in America actually need. What I am bringing to you today is not a new idea. It is the architecture that the idea has always deserved.

For generations you have taught that Black people in America must build their own economy, own their own land, govern their own communities, and stop begging a system built on our oppression to treat us fairly. You have been right. I share this vision, Minister Farrakhan, and I believe the time to build it has come. ACE introduces a legal and structural foundation, the architecture that turns decades of righteous teaching into a city our people can build, grow and live in.

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment (ACE) is that blueprint.

ACE is a 25-year initiative to establish a network of self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities on tribal sovereign land land that sits outside state jurisdiction, outside federal taxation of tribal enterprise, and outside many of the legal mechanisms that have historically been used to destroy Black economic and political institutions the moment they became powerful enough to threaten the status quo.

The tribal sovereignty partnership is not symbolic. It is a legal architecture that has survived 200 years of federal attempts to dismantle it. It is the most durable legal protection available to a Black community organization in the United States. And it is available to ACE because Black and Native Americans are natural allies; two peoples dispossessed by the same government, with complementary assets: land and sovereignty on one side, capital and population on the other.

What ACE is building: Cities with their own schools, their own hospitals, their own courts, their own police a peacekeeping corps accountable to the community, not to the state. Their own banks. Their own farms. Their own media. Their own constitution. Their own government. Everything your theology has called for. Architected. Legal. Buildable.

WHY ACE HAD TO BE BUILT

The founding documents of the United States did not accidentally exclude Black and Native people. They excluded us by design, with specificity, and in writing. We do not dispute that. What ACE disputes is the conclusion that the remedy lives inside the same architecture that produced the exclusion. The Constitution is not failing its purpose. It is fulfilling it. We are not surprised. And we are not waiting for it to change. Nor are we asking to change it. Every activist, every movement, every piece of legislation that came before ACE was built on the belief that the system could be made to serve the people it was designed to exclude, operating under the ideal that if enough laws changed, hearts would follow. And many of those efforts produced real and hard-won gains.

But no act of Congress, no Supreme Court ruling, no constitutional amendment has ever been able to legislate what lives in the hearts of the people responsible for enforcing it. The law can change. The man holding the law does not have to. Four hundred years of evidence has made that clear. It is not out of spite, and it is not out of hatred, that ACE builds outside the jurisdiction of a document that was never written with as much as a suggestion of serving our communities. It is out of the only honest conclusion the evidence permits: that the freedom, sovereignty, and dignity Black and Native people deserve cannot be granted by a system designed to deny it. Any system built to truly serve our communities must be built by those communities, on their own ground, under their own authority.

For decades you have said that Black people in America cannot petition their way to freedom, cannot integrate their way to sovereignty, and cannot build lasting power inside institutions designed to contain them. The evidence has agreed with you every time.

What has been missing is not the vision. It is the blueprint. ACE provides the legal architecture and the territorial foundation, secured either through partnership with aligned tribal nations or through the same federal sovereignty protections already extended to recognized tribes. It provides the governing constitution and the economic model.

Everything you have been calling for, now architected and ready to build. We are not asking you to become ACE. We are showing you that what you have preached is now buildable, and we believe you should be part of building it.

THE ASK

We are not asking you to become ACE. We are showing you that what you have been calling for is now blueprinted and ready to build. We believe you should be part of it.

- We are asking for your endorsement of this initiative to your community, the people who trust your voice and have been ready for this moment longer than anyone.
- We are asking for your organization's participation as an ACE Community Ministry Partner connecting your network to ACE town halls, investment opportunities, and community development resources.
- We are asking for your introduction to others within your sphere of influence who share this vision and have the resources to invest in it.

The door is open. The proposal is enclosed. Let's meet.

***The vision you have preached for generations is now architected.
We built it.***

The full ACE Act is enclosed. Thank you for your time.

SUPPORTING LEGAL DOCUMENTATION, AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST

The following documents have been prepared and are available to you upon request:

- **ACE Sovereign Territory Act: Companion Legal Brief v1.0** - Pre-argument legal defense of ACE's contingency land claim: 33.15 million acres of existing federal public land across ten states, grounded in a precise calculation: 47 million Black Americans at 0.705 acres per person, less than two percent of the 40-acre promise made and broken in the same year.
- **ACE Submission to the United Nations CERD v1.0** - Formal submission to the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination's active General Recommendation on reparations for chattel enslavement, filed June 2026. The international accountability track the NOI has called for.

DIRECT CONTACT

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